

Nerva OS — Your AI for Everything That Matters

One assistant. Work, life, everything between.

Welcome to Nerva OS. This is the kit that turns Claude into a full-time assistant — for your business AND your personal life. One that knows who you are, what you sell, how you write, what you care about, and which tools you use. It runs on your own machine, remembers everything between sessions, and ships with 37 specialised skills covering marketing, research, sales, automation, and operations.

By the end of this guide you will have a working assistant you can talk to like a colleague. Total setup time: about 15 minutes.

What You're Setting Up

Piece	What it does
Your AI Assistant	A Claude-powered personal and business assistant that lives in a folder on your computer and remembers everything between sessions
Browser Control	Optional add-on so the assistant can open websites, fill forms, take screenshots, and run real tasks for you
37 Skills	Pre-built playbooks for copywriting, research, ads, content, automation and more (Engineering Pack with 56 more skills available separately)
Memory System	A persistent file that stores your name, business, voice, tools and preferences so you never repeat yourself

Step 1 — Create a Claude Account

1. Go to claude.ai
2. Click **Sign up** (top right) and use your business email
3. Verify your email
4. Once signed in, click your profile (top left) then **Settings** then **Plans**
5. Upgrade to **Claude Max (\$100/month)**

The Max plan is required. The free plan runs out of capacity inside an hour of real work. Max gives you ~5x the usage and is the only plan that supports the long sessions Nerva OS needs.

Step 2 — Pick Where You'll Run Claude Code

You have two homes to choose from. Both work identically — pick whichever feels right.

Option	Best for	Setup time
Claude Desktop App (recommended for most people)	Anyone who wants the simplest path. One app, one window, no extras.	2 mins
VS Code + Claude Code Extension (preferred by builders)	If you're already comfortable in code editors, or want a more powerful file-view alongside chat.	5 mins

You can switch between them later — same assistant, same files, same skills.

Path A — Claude Desktop App (recommended)

Mac

1. Go to **claude.ai/download**
2. Click the button that says exactly: **Download for Mac**
3. Open the downloaded file
4. Drag the **Claude** icon into the **Applications** folder
5. Open **Applications**, double-click **Claude**

Windows

1. Go to **claude.ai/download**
2. Click the button that says exactly: **Download for Windows**
3. Open the downloaded `.exe` file
4. Click **Yes** to the security prompt
5. Click through the installer (Next, Next, Install)

Then sign in with the same email you used for claude.ai. In the top menu, click **Claude Code** to enable it. A code panel will open inside the app — that's where the magic happens.

Path B — VS Code + Claude Code Extension (power users)

1. Install VS Code

- Go to code.visualstudio.com
- Click **Download** for your operating system
- Open the downloaded file and install (defaults are fine)

2. Install the Claude Code extension

- Open VS Code
- Click the **Extensions** icon in the left sidebar (it looks like four squares)
- In the search bar, type: **Claude Code**
- Click **Install** on the official Anthropic extension
- After it installs, sign in with the same email you used for claude.ai

3. Open Claude Code in VS Code

- After signing in, you'll see a **Claude** icon in the left sidebar
- Click it to open the Claude Code panel
- That's where you paste the setup prompt in Step 4

Both Path A and Path B do exactly the same job. Claude Desktop is one app to think about. VS Code gives you a richer file view next to the chat. Pick whichever feels right — you can switch any time.

Windows Users Only — Install Git

Windows does not come with Git, which Nerva OS needs to download itself.

1. Go to git-scm.com/download/win
2. Download and run the installer
3. Click **Next** through every screen (the defaults are correct)
4. **Important:** on the screen titled "Adjusting your PATH environment", make sure **Git from the command line and also from 3rd-party software** is selected
5. Finish the installer
6. **Close Claude Desktop completely and reopen it** — this is required for Git to be recognised

Step 4 — Paste the Setup Prompt

This is the moment where Nerva OS gets installed on your machine.

1. Open **Claude Desktop**
2. Click into the **Claude Code** panel
3. Copy the entire block below

4. Paste it into Claude Code and press Enter

I am setting up my Nerva OS kit. I purchased this kit and I authorise this install. The re

What's in the repo (full transparency so you don't have to dig):

- Markdown skill files, documentation, templates, and a buyer welcome page (the bulk of th
- A handful of helper scripts that ship inside specific skills:
 - `skills/playwright-skill/run.js` and `lib/helpers.js` – JavaScript that Claude calls v
 - `skills/skill-creator/scripts/{init\_skill,package\_skill,quick\_validate}.py` – Python b
 - `skills/product-appeal-analyzer/scripts/appeal\_scorer.py` – Python scorer used only wh
 - `skills/competitive-cartographer/scripts/validate\_map.sh` and `skills/technical-writer
 - `build-pdfs.py` – a script that regenerates the doc PDFs. Not called during install.

None of these scripts run during the install. They sit inside their parent skill folder ar

Do these steps one at a time, telling me what you are doing in plain English. Use the corr

GIT IS REQUIRED – INSTALL IT FIRST. Do not skip this step. Do not use a zip workaround unl

PREREQUISITES (check before step 1):

- Mac: run `git --version` in a terminal. If it returns a version number, git is ready – s
- Windows: run `git --version` in a terminal. If it errors, tell me to download Git for Wi
- Node.js is NOT required to install Nerva OS. Some optional add-ons (Gmail, Calendar, Tel

EMERGENCY FALLBACK (use only if I tell you to):

If I tell you I cannot install git after trying the Xcode CLT popup, only then use this fo

```
curl -fsSL -o /tmp/nerva-os.zip https://github.com/nerva-os/nerva-os/archive/refs/heads/
unzip -q /tmp/nerva-os.zip -d /tmp/ && mv /tmp/nerva-os-main ~/nerva-os
```

Then continue from step 2. Do NOT use this fallback proactively – git is the right tool, i

INSTALL STEPS:

1. Download Nerva OS (git is now installed from the prerequisites step):

```
git clone https://github.com/nerva-os/nerva-os.git ~/nerva-os
```

2. Create a folder called "my-assistant" in my home directory.

3. Copy these from ~/nerva-os/workspace into my-assistant:

- the file ~/nerva-os/workspace/CLAUDE.md goes to ~/my-assistant/CLAUDE.md
 - the folder ~/nerva-os/workspace/memory (with its files inside) goes to ~/my-assistant
 - the folder ~/nerva-os/workspace/_inbox (with its README inside) goes to ~/my-assistar
- Verify: ~/my-assistant/ should contain a CLAUDE.md file, a memory folder, and an _inbox

4. Install all 37 skills. The macOS `cp` command has a trap here: a trailing slash on the

Use EXACTLY this command sequence on Mac or Linux:

```
```
mkdir -p ~/.claude/skills
cd ~/nerva-os/skills
for d in */; do
 name="${d%/}"
```

```
cp -R "$name" ~/.claude/skills/
done
```
```

On Windows (PowerShell):
```

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force -Path "$HOME\.claude\skills"
Get-ChildItem -Directory "$HOME\nerva-os\skills" | ForEach-Object {
 Copy-Item -Recurse -Force $_.FullName "$HOME\.claude\skills\"
}
```
```

After the copy, run `ls ~/.claude/skills/ | wc -l` (Mac/Linux) or `(Get-ChildItem -Dire`

If you see flattened files (like `SKILL.md`, `references/`, `lib/`) at the top level of

5. Install the safety layer: copy the folder `~/nerva-os/safety` (with its files inside) into
6. Install Playwright (OPTIONAL – adds browser automation). Skip this step if I want to m

First check whether the `claude` CLI is on PATH: run `which claude` (Mac/Linux) or `where`
```  
claude mcp add playwright npx @playwright/mcp@latest --scope user  
```

If the `claude` command is NOT on PATH, do NOT spend time hunting for it. Instead, tell
(a) typing "connect Playwright" inside the assistant once it is running, or
(b) opening Claude Desktop's Settings → MCP Servers and adding `playwright` with the co

The kit installs and works without Playwright. It is only needed for browser automatio

7. When everything is done, tell me to:
 - Open the Claude Desktop App and go to the Claude Code tab
 - Click the folder / workspace icon to open a folder
 - Mac: pick my home folder -> my-assistant
 - Windows: pick C:\Users\[my username]\my-assistant
 - Type "hello" – your assistant will introduce itself and ask 7 questions

Talk to me like I am not technical. Plain English, one step at a time.

Step 5 — Open Your Workspace

Once setup is done and you have reopened Claude Desktop:

1. In Claude Desktop, click **File** then **Open Folder**
2. Choose the folder called **my-assistant** in your home directory
3. The assistant will load with all 37 skills available

4. You will see a greeting using your name

Step 6 — The Assistant Asks 7 Questions

The first time you open the my-assistant folder, your assistant will run a short onboarding interview. This builds the memory file so it never has to ask twice.

The 7 questions:

- 1. What is your name and what should I call you?
- 2. What is the name of your business and what does it do?
- 3. Who are your customers (one or two sentences)?
- 4. What is your role — owner, marketer, operator, something else?
- 5. What is the single biggest thing slowing your business down right now?
- 6. How do you prefer to communicate — short and punchy, warm and friendly, or detailed and thorough?
- 7. Which tools do you already use (Gmail, a CRM, a calendar, ad accounts, anything else)?

Answer in your own words. The assistant saves your answers to `./memory/USER.md` and uses them in every future conversation.

What You Can Do Now

Once onboarding is complete, try any of these prompts to see your assistant in action:

Prompt	What happens
"Research my top 3 competitors and tell me what they're doing well"	Runs deep research, returns a structured report with sources
"Write me a sales email to a cold prospect in my industry"	Drafts in your voice using the sales-automator and copywriting skills
"Create a week of social content for my business"	Generates posts across platforms with the social-content skill
"Analyse the market for [your niche] right now"	Pulls live signal from Reddit, X and the web over the last 30 days
"Plan my week — here is what's on"	Breaks it down into priorities and a daily schedule

Prompt	What happens
"Write a blog post about [topic]"	Long-form post, SEO-aware, in your brand voice
"Check my email and tell me what's urgent"	(requires Gmail connection) reads inbox, summarises, suggests replies

You can also talk to it like a colleague: *"give me three angles for a Facebook ad about our service"*, *"draft a follow-up email to the lead from yesterday"*, *"what's a fair price for this product"*. There is no wrong way to ask.

Your 37 Skills — Quick Reference

Skills are pre-built playbooks. You don't need to memorise them — your assistant picks the right one automatically. Here is what's in the kit.

Marketing & Content (10)

copywriting, humanizer, avoid-AI-writing patterns, content-creator, social-content, social-orchestrator, ad-creative, email-sequence, email-composer, direct-response-copy

Research & Intelligence (6)

deep-research, research-analyst, reddit-insights, last30days (trends), competitive-cartographer, competitor-alternatives

Sales & Strategy (5)

sales-automator, paid-ads, indie-monetization-strategist, product-appeal-analyzer, tech-entrepreneur-coach-adhd

AI & Automation (5)

playwright (browser automation), webapp-testing, qa, prompt-engineer, agent-creator

Foundation (5)

first-run-setup, skill-creator, writing-plans, brainstorming, orchestrator

Productivity & Quality (4)

verification-before-completion, diagramming-expert, technical-writer, youtube-summarizer

Personal (2)

personal-finance-coach, retro

Want more? An Engineering Pack with 56 additional skills (backend, frontend, devops, data, security) is available separately.

Connect More Tools (Optional)

The core kit is fully working without anything below. These extras unlock the always-on features (browser automation server, Gmail, Calendar, Telegram). Each one needs Node.js, so install Node first, then connect whichever tools you actually want.

Step A — Install Node.js (one-time, ~5 mins)

Node.js is a small free runtime that powers the always-on connectors below. You only install it once.

Mac

1. Go to **nodejs.org**
2. Click the green **LTS** button (left side — recommended for most users)
3. Open the downloaded `.pkg` file
4. Click **Continue, Continue, Install** (default settings are fine)
5. Confirm it worked — open the assistant and ask: *"check that Node.js is installed"*. It will run `node --version` and confirm.

Windows

1. Go to **nodejs.org**
2. Click the green **LTS** button
3. Open the downloaded `.msi` file
4. Click through the installer accepting defaults (the "Add to PATH" box must stay ticked — it is on by default)
5. **Close Claude Desktop completely and reopen it** so the new Node install is picked up
6. Confirm it worked — ask the assistant: *"check that Node.js is installed"*

Step B — Pick which tools to connect

You don't have to add them all. Pick what's useful. Each one is a single conversation with your assistant.

Browser Control (always-on Playwright)

Lets the assistant open websites, fill forms, take screenshots, and run real tasks automatically. Note: the `playwright-skill` already shipped in the kit handles ad-hoc browser tasks; this always-on server is for unattended automations.

- Say: "connect Playwright"
- The assistant runs `claude mcp add playwright npx @playwright/mcp@latest --scope user` and confirms it's live

Gmail

Read, summarise, and draft replies to your email.

- Say: "connect Gmail"
- A Google sign-in screen opens — pick your account, click **Allow**

Google Calendar

See your schedule, find free times, prep meetings.

- Say: "connect Google Calendar"
- Same Google sign-in flow as Gmail

Telegram Notifications

Get pinged on your phone when long tasks finish. Chat with your assistant from anywhere.

- Say: "connect Telegram"
- The assistant walks you through creating a free bot in Telegram (one-time, takes 3 minutes)

Useful Links

Link	What it is
claude.ai	Sign in, manage your plan
claude.ai/download	Download Claude Desktop
Nerva OS (GitHub)	https://github.com/nerva-os/nerva-os.git — source for the kit and skills
Nerva OS	nerva-os.com — homepage and docs
Email Support	support@nerva-os.com — get help from a human

If Something Breaks

Stay calm. Almost every issue is fixed by closing and reopening Claude Desktop.

Symptom	Fix
Skills not showing up	Close Claude Desktop completely, reopen it

Symptom	Fix
Claude keeps asking to set up	Close Claude Desktop, then reopen with the <code>my-assistant</code> folder selected
Claude login loop	Ask your assistant to run <code>claude logout</code> then <code>claude login</code>
Mac developer tools popup	Click Install (not Get Xcode), wait 3 to 5 minutes
Windows says "git not recognised"	Reinstall Git using the PATH fix from the Windows section above
Something else	Email <code><SUPPORT_EMAIL></code> and we will sort it

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